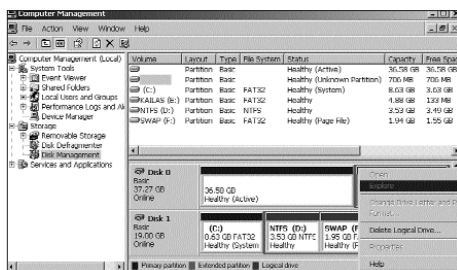


in Windows. So, while you are in Windows, free up two partitions by transferring all your data to other partitions. For the main partition (called *slash*, represented by the “/” symbol—this is explained in detail later on), you will need about 2 to 6 GB (depending on the packages you choose) if you are installing the newest version of Fedora, Mandriva or SUSE. Also, have in place about 500 MB for the swap file. If you don’t have a second partition or can’t free up a 500 MB partition, you can create it from the main partition you just freed up. Use a partition management tool such as Partition Magic if you are familiar with it, or alternatively, use the Windows Disk Management tool.

2.1.2.1 The Disk Management tool in Windows XP

Go to *My Computer* > *Manage*, and click on *Disk Management* under *Storage*. Now select the partition you freed up, and right-click on it. Choose ‘Delete Logical Partition’. Right-click on what now appears as Free or Unallocated Space, and create a 500 MB partition on it, choosing any filesystem.



The Windows Disk Management Tool

You now have one partition for the Linux installation, and another small one for the swap file. Make a note of the approximate free space, so you can identify this partition later on. With this done, you can start with your Linux installation.

Note that the process of allocating disk space can also be done during the installation, but the above method is a lot easier and straight forward for inexperienced users.

2.1.3 Booting from the CD

The next thing to do is restart your computer and change the first boot device to CD-ROM. To do this you need to enter the BIOS